

XIAOZHI (TARO) YANG

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EDUCATION & ACADEMIC TRAINING

MindCORE Fellow , University of Pennsylvania <i>Advisors:</i> Sudeep Bhatia, Joe Kable, Anna Schapiro	01/2025- present
PennAI Fellow , University of Pennsylvania	08/2025- present
Visiting Graduate Student/Postdoc , UCLA	08/2023 – 12/2024
Ph.D. , The Ohio State University <i>Major:</i> Psychology <i>Graduate minor in Statistics program</i> <i>Advisor:</i> Ian Krajbich	05/2024
B.S. , University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign <i>Majors:</i> Psychology & Statistics (double majors)	05/2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Decision making, Learning, Cognitive computational modelling

PUBLICATIONS & WORKING PAPERS

- Yang, X.**, ... & Kable, J. Attribute-guided attention is an adaptive mechanism for efficient search during naturalistic decision-making. *Preprint*
- Fernandez, K., **Yang, X.**, Smith, S., Krajbich, I. Defending against AI agents with webcam eye tracking. *Preprint*
- Yang, X.**, Zhang, Z., Ming, H., & Krajbich, I. A dynamic computational account of decisions with self-generated options. Under revision in *Science Advance*
- Yang, X.** & Bhatia S. Dynamic attribute activation explains gaze biases in choice. Under revision in *PNAS*
- Yang, X.** & Krajbich, I. (2023) A dynamic computational model of gaze and choice in multi-attribute decisions. *Psychological Review*
- Yang, X.**, Riggs, E., Coroneil, J., & Krajbich, I. (2025) Issue importance amplifies the effect of gaze on voting decisions. *Cognition*
- Yang, X.** & Krajbich, I. (2021) Webcam-based online eye-tracking for behavioral research. *Judgment and Decision Making*
- Yang, X.**, Retzler, C., Ratcliff, R., Philastides, MG, Krajbich, I. (2024) Attention to brand labels affects and is affected by evaluations of product attractiveness. *Frontiers in Behavior Economics*
- Cavnar, D., **Yang, X.**, & Regenwetter, M. (2024) Choose for others as you would choose for yourself? A layered analysis of probabilistic preferential choice across social distance. *Journal of Economic Psychology*

Krajbich, I., Fernandez, K., & **Yang, X.** (2024, September 6). Decomposing economic choices with drift-diffusion models. *Book Chapter for Neuroeconomics: Core Topics and Current Directions, Springer*

Yang, X., Singh, D., Bhatia, S., Schapiro, A. (2026) Interactions of hippocampal category learning with prior knowledge. *Proceedings of Cognitive Computational Neuroscience Conference*

HONORS & AWARDS

<i>Penn AI Fellowship, Philadelphia, PA</i>	2025
<i>MindCORE Fellowship, Philadelphia, PA</i>	2025
<i>Associate for Consumer Research Conference Travel Award, Seattle, WA</i>	2023
<i>Neuroeconomics Summer School Travel Scholarship, Philadelphia, PA</i>	2023
<i>Herbert Toops Research Award, The Ohio State University</i>	2023
<i>CCBS Graduate Research Award, The Ohio State University</i>	2023
<i>Distinguished University Fellowship, The Ohio State University</i>	2019 – 2020
<i>Janet Tritsch Memorial Award, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign</i>	2019
<i>Highest Distinctions, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign</i>	2019
<i>James Spoor Scholarship, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign</i>	2018

RESEARCH GRANTS

Google Cloud Research Credit Program, Google	2026-2027
Research Grant (\$6000, with \$1000 GenAI research credits)	
Proposal: The dynamics of querying process with language models	
Center for Socially Responsible AI, Penn State University	2026-2028
Research Grant (\$19680, Co-PI: Yuchen Yang, School of Information Science)	
Proposal: Persuasion-aware explanations for safer AI-mediated decisions	
Decision Science Collaborative, The Ohio State University	2023-2024
Research Grant (\$3000, Supervisor: Ian Krajbich, Department of Psychology & Economics)	
Proposal: The role of social perception in social learning	

CONFERENCE TALKS

<i>Society for Mathematical Psychology, online</i>	2026
<i>Philadelphia Decision Neuroscience Symposium, Philadelphia, PA</i>	2026
<i>Society of Judgment and Decision Making, Denver, CO</i>	2025
<i>Society of Neuroeconomics, Boston, MA</i>	2025
<i>Society of Judgment and Decision Making, New York, NY</i>	2024
<i>Association for Consumer Research, Seattle, WA</i>	2023
<i>Cognitive Development Society Conference, Madison, WI</i>	2022
<i>European Group of Process Tracing Annual Meeting, Online</i>	2021

Society for Mathematical Psychology, Online 2021

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Computational Cognitive Neuroscience, New York, NY 2026
Society of Judgment and Decision Making, Denver, CO 2025
Society of Judgment and Decision Making, San Francisco, CA 2023
Interdisciplinary Symposium on Decision Neuroscience, Philadelphia, PA 2023
Society for Neuroeconomics, Washington, DC 2022
Decision Science Collaborative Spring Forum, Columbus, OH 2022
Interdisciplinary Symposium on Decision Neuroscience, Online 2021
Society for Neuroeconomics, Online 2020, 2021
Society for Mathematical Psychology, Madison, WI 2018

INVITED TALKS

Creativity lab, Penn State University, PA, US 2025
Memory, Belief, and Choice Seminar, University of Pennsylvania, PA, US 2025
Social Psychology Group Meeting, University of Pennsylvania, PA, US 2025
MindCORE, University of Pennsylvania, PA, US 2024
Shenhav lab, Department of Psychology, UC Berkeley, CA, US 2024
School of Management, UCLA, CA, US 2023
School of Management, Zhejiang University, China 2023
Center for Comparative Psycholinguistics, University of Alberta, CA 2022

WORKSHOPS & EVENTS

Beyond Academia, Philadelphia, PA (2026)
Role: Presenter
Process Tracing Workshop, New York, NY (2024)
Role: Organizer/Presenter

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor

Penn AI Summer Hangouts Series, University of Pennsylvania, Summer, 2026

Teaching Assistant

Decision Neuroscience and Neuroeconomics, The Ohio State University, Spring, 2023
Intro to Cognitive Psychology, The Ohio State University, Spring, 2023
Intro to Statistics, The Ohio State University, Spring, 2024

CONSULTING/PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Snap, Inc 08.2022 – 02.2023
Research Intern, Computational Social Science team
Santa Monica, CA
Meta, Inc (Facebook) 05.2022 – 08.2022
Data Science Intern, AI Data Science, FAIR research
Menlo Park, CA

MENTORING EXPERIENCES

University of Pennsylvania

Adarsh Ramamurthy, undergrad at Department of Bioengineering
Yiyang Zhang, master student at Department of Biotechnology
Hallie Li, undergrad at Department of Psychology

UCLA

Qingyang Wang, PhD student at UCLA Anderson
Evelyn Xu, undergrad at UCLA Psychology

Ohio State

Jocelyn Xie, undergrad at Department of Psychology
Nicholas Kudlapur, undergrad at Department of Psychology
Nick McNeal, undergrad at Department of Computer Science

SERVICE

Conference Reviewer

Cognitive Computational Neuroscience Conference
The International Conference for Computational Social Science
Proceeding of Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society
European Association of Consumer Research

Journal Reviewer

Communication Psychology
Scientific Report
Journal of Choice Modelling
Health Communication
Journal of Perceptual Imaging